



# Smoke-ready home plan

Choose a cleaner-air room and a backup destination before smoky days arrive.

**Follow evacuation instructions first.** A cleaner-air room cannot make it safe to stay near an approaching fire. Leave when ordered, or sooner if you feel unsafe. Call 911 for an emergency.

## SET UP YOUR ROOM

- ☐ Choose a room large enough for your household. Close doors and windows during smoke only while it remains safe and comfortably cool. Keep exits usable.
- ☐ Use a mechanical-filter air cleaner, such as HEPA, sized for the room. Choose a CARB-certified model that doesn't generate ozone. Keep airflow around it clear.
- ☐ Run the cleaner continuously at its highest practical setting. Keep spare filters available and check them during smoke events.
- ☐ For central HVAC, ask which filter fits your system. MERV 13 or higher may help if compatible. Learn recirculation and fan settings before smoke arrives.
- ☐ Reduce indoor particles: skip candles, incense, smoking, vaping and frying. Use a damp cloth for settled dust.

Our cleaner-air room

Air cleaner / filter type / spare filters stored at

HVAC settings confirmed with / date

## PLAN AROUND HEALTH NEEDS

Ask your clinician what to do during smoke if anyone has heart or lung disease or other health needs. Keep prescribed medicines and your existing care plan accessible. Contact your clinician if symptoms worsen.

Clinician / pharmacy phone

## OFFICIAL SOURCES

[EPA: create a clean room](#)

[EPA: indoor air filtration](#)

[AirNow: fires and your health](#)



# When smoke reaches the valley

Check both air quality and heat. Keep your backup plan ready.

- ☐ Check [fire.airnow.gov](https://fire.airnow.gov) for outdoor air quality and [weather.gov](https://weather.gov) for heat. Read current CruzAware alerts. AQI describes air pollution, not evacuation status.
- ☐ Limit strenuous outdoor activity and reschedule nonessential chores. If you must go outside, a well-fitting N95 can reduce smoke-particle exposure; cloth masks don't provide that protection.
- ☐ If heat, heavy smoke entering the house, or a power outage defeats your plan, seek a cooler place with cleaner air.

**Don't remain in a dangerously hot, closed house to keep smoke out.** Heat may be the more immediate danger. If you cannot relocate promptly, follow EPA's smoke-and-heat guidance for cooling your home. An air cleaner depends on power and doesn't replace a backup destination.

## CHOOSE SOMEWHERE ELSE TO GO

Arrange a friend or relative's home with cooling and filtration. Check official announcements for open cleaner-air or cooling locations; call 211 for referrals. Confirm hours, accessibility, pet arrangements and transport before relying on a location.

First destination / phone

Backup destination / phone

Ride or helper / phone / pet arrangements

Medical or equipment needs to bring

Conditions that mean we'll move / plan checked on

## OFFICIAL SOURCES

[AirNow: when smoke is in the air](#)

[EPA: smoke and heat](#)

[County: CruzAware registration](#)